

SkyJet Airways

Self-Service Flight Recovery

Customer Journey — A Passenger's-Eye Walkthrough

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What a customer sees, taps, and gets — from the moment their flight is disrupted to the moment they are on their way again. Companion to the feature specification; this document is the **customer walk**: every screen and every branch, in plain language.

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Design principles (USER EXPERIENCE)

- **KISS —> Keep It Simple, Stupid.** One decision per screen. The passenger is already stressed; the app never adds to it. No jargon, no dead ends, no forms longer than they need to be.
- **It is a website, not an app.** The passenger does not download anything. They tap a link (or scan a QR code) and it opens instantly in their phone's browser — nothing to install, nothing to log into, no app-store friction while standing at a gate.
- **Mobile-first by default.** The layout is built for a phone held in one hand — a single narrow column, big tap targets, the most urgent information at the top. This is how nearly everyone will actually use it during a disruption.
- **Desktop view on demand.** A toggle at the top switches between Mobile View and Desktop View. Desktop widens the layout into a two-column board (details on the left, assistant and actions on the right) for anyone on a laptop or presenting on a big screen.
- **Boarding-pass look and feel.** The visual language mirrors a real boarding pass — the same card shape, the origin-to-destination layout, the sky-blue gradient header, a scannable QR. It feels familiar and trustworthy because it looks like the document the passenger already knows.
- **Explainability everywhere.** Every decision the app makes (“no cash compensation”, “you are owed a hotel”, “this is the best flight”) is shown with its reason and the rule behind it. The passenger is never told “no” without being told “why”.

The journey at a glance

Four stages, with two escape hatches always within reach at every step: “Talk to an agent instead” and the “Ask about your options” assistant.

Stage	What the passenger does	What they get
1. Entry	Scan the QR / tap the alert link, or type PNR + last name, or tap a demo scenario	Lands inside their disrupted booking, already identified
2. Flight details	Reads what happened	How late they are, the route & timeline, the reason, and what they are entitled to
Fork	(automatic) needs a specialist?	If yes → warm agent handoff. If no → the three choices below
3. Choose	Picks one: Rebook, Refund, or Wait	A new boarding pass, a refund reference, or a clear plan to wait

Step 1 — The passenger arrives

There are three ways in, and all of them land in the same place: the disrupted booking, already identified.

A. The proactive alert (the intended happy path)

SkyJet reaches out **first** — before the passenger even thinks to call. They receive a WhatsApp message:

“Your flight SJ 301 (DEL → BKK) is cancelled due to weather. We have held a seat for you on the next flight. Recover in under 30 seconds — no need to call.”

The message carries a **QR code** and an “Open self-service” button. The passenger either scans the QR or taps the button — and the website opens straight into their booking. **No PNR typing, no login screen.** The QR/link securely encodes the booking reference, so the app knows who they are the moment it opens.

B. Manual lookup (for anyone who comes on their own)

If a passenger opens the website directly, they see a simple two-field card:

- **Booking reference (PNR)** — e.g. SJ7QK2
- **Last name** — e.g. Sharma

One tap on “Find my booking” and they are in. Wrong details get a friendly error, not a wall.

C. Demo scenarios (for judges / testing)

A row of one-tap scenario buttons — weather cancellation, technical cancellation, 5-hour delay, unaccompanied minor, senior with priority seat, standard waitlisted — lets anyone jump straight into a realistic case.

Security note the passenger does not see: the PNR + last name that got them in are re-checked on the server for every action afterwards (rebook, refund, handoff), so no one can act on a booking that is not theirs.

Step 2 — “What happened to my flight?”

The first thing the passenger sees after being identified answers the only question on their mind: how late am I?

1. **Delay / cancellation banner** — a big, colour-coded headline at the very top. Cancelled shows a red “Flight cancelled”; a delay shows an amber “Delayed by 5h 20m” with the new estimated departure vs. the original. It greets them by first name.
2. **Status card** — the boarding-pass-style detail card: origin → destination, flight number, times, a flight-progress timeline, and a live ops strip (inbound aircraft, gate, ETA) — the same picture the airline has, so there is no information gap. The reason is stated plainly (“Reason: Weather” or “Technical / crew”) because the cause decides what the passenger is owed, so it is never hidden. Their PNR, name, and loyalty tier show as small badges, alongside an empathetic line.
3. **“What you are entitled to”** — the eligibility panel, always visible. Four clear rows, each marked Included or Not applicable with a reason:
 - Free rebooking
 - Full refund (with the amount)
 - Cash compensation (with the amount, when owed)
 - Care during the wait (meals / hotel)

Crucially, the **basis for the decision** is spelled out. For example:

“Not eligible for cash compensation because the cause is weather — an extraordinary circumstance under DGCA rules. But you are entitled to a free rebooking, a full refund, and hotel accommodation.”

If a refund is on the table, there is a reassuring safety net: *“Prefer to decide later? If you take no action, we will automatically refund you within 24 hours.”*

4. **A goodwill card** (when the airline has extended one) — “With our apologies” — listing any complimentary meal, hotel, or discount on the next flight, clearly marked as a gesture on top of the statutory entitlements.

The fork: automate, or hand to a human

If the booking needs a specialist → Agent handoff

Some situations are deliberately **not** automated — they need a human. The app detects these and, instead of the three options, shows a calm card, “A specialist should handle this,” listing the reasons: unaccompanied minor, group / multi-city, partner-airline or award ticket, no valid rebooking in policy, or a disputed / OTA booking.

One tap on “Connect me to an agent” performs a **warm handoff**: the passenger gets a case reference and sees exactly what context was handed to the agent — PNR, the disruption, and

what they had already tried. The promise, shown on screen: “The agent already has everything above — you will not need to repeat yourself.”

This option is also **always available manually** — a “Talk to an agent instead” link sits under the three choices on every booking, for anyone who simply prefers a human.

Otherwise → the passenger chooses

Under the heading “What would you like to do?”, up to three big, tappable options appear. Which ones show depends on the situation:

Option	Shown when	One-line promise
Rebook the flight	always	Move to the next available SkyJet flight — free of charge.
Refund & cancel	when a refund is due	Cancel and get a full refund of ₹X.
Wait for this flight	only for delays (not cancellations)	Keep your seat and travel on the delayed flight.

Tapping one expands it inline — no page reload, no losing your place.

Step 3a — If the passenger chooses REBOOK

The goal: a new boarding pass in a few taps, with a smart recommendation so they do not have to weigh every option themselves.

1. Choose your new flight

- The ★ **Recommended — best option** is highlighted at the top, with a plain-English reason (e.g. “Same day, 3 hours later, direct — the soonest we can get you there”), how many seats are left, and the fare difference (₹0 / no fare difference when the disruption was the airline's fault).
- Below it, “Or choose a different flight” lists the other alternatives, each with its own reason, timing, seats, and fare tag.
- If a flight's seats are being held for higher-priority passengers, it shows a waitlist note instead of a seat button — gently steering the passenger to a flight with more room.

2. Pick your seat — a real, tappable aircraft seat map

- A **priority banner** explains the passenger's standing — Senior, Business, Child/Infant, or Standard — and what it means for them (e.g. a senior citizen is 1st priority and gets first pick of the good seats).
- The map shows the whole cabin: available, priority, your seat, and occupied. Priority seats near the front are reserved (locked) for higher-priority passengers when a standard passenger still has other free seats — fair, and visibly so.
- The app pre-selects the best seat the passenger's priority entitles them to, so they can just confirm. A summary shows the chosen seat (window/aisle/middle) and any fare difference.

3. Confirm

The button says exactly what will happen — “Confirm seat 14A & get boarding pass”, or “Pay ₹X more & confirm seat” / “Confirm · ₹X refund” if fares differ. Tapping it is **safe to double-tap** — the system guarantees a stray second tap cannot double-book (an idempotency key plus a version check, behind the scenes).

4. You are rebooked

The success screen delivers:

- A green “You are rebooked — your new boarding pass is ready, no call, no queue.”
- The new boarding pass in full boarding-pass styling: route, times, gate, seat, boarding time, sequence, PNR, and a scannable QR to manage it.
- A note that checked baggage is being re-routed automatically to the new flight.
- Any fare-difference settlement, stated clearly, plus the goodwill card if applicable.
- A “Check in for this flight” button — one tap to check in and proceed to the gate.

Step 3b — If the passenger chooses REFUND

Shown only when a refund is actually due, so the passenger is never offered something they cannot have.

1. Confirm refund & cancel

A plain card: “We will cancel SJ 301 and refund the full fare to your original payment method. This cannot be undone.” The exact refund amount is shown. One deliberate confirm tap.

2. Refund initiated

The passenger gets:

- A green “Refund initiated — you will see it on your original payment method soon.”
- A **refund reference number** (the app issues a reference, not a live payment — mirroring how a real refund is tracked) and the amount.
- A note that a confirmation has been emailed to them.
- Any goodwill gesture, still honoured.

Step 3c — If the passenger chooses WAIT (delays only)

For a delay, some passengers just want to keep their existing flight. This option makes that a first-class, reassuring choice rather than “do nothing”.

- **“You are keeping this flight”** — confirmation that no change is needed; they will travel on the same flight.
- The new estimated departure vs. the originally scheduled time, side by side.
- Their care entitlements while they wait (meals if the delay is long enough, a hotel if it is overnight) — surfaced right here so they know to claim them.
- A promise: “We will notify you on WhatsApp if the departure time changes again.”
- The escape hatch: “You can still rebook or request a refund any time before departure.” — waiting is never a trap.

While the passenger is on this screen (or still deciding), the app **quietly polls the flight in the background** — so if ops pushes a further delay, a boarding call, or a cancellation, it updates on screen without a refresh.

Always available: “Ask about your options”

Alongside the actions sits a small chat panel, “Ask about your options.” The passenger can ask free-form questions in their own words:

- “Should I refund or rebook?”
- “Am I owed a hotel tonight?”

- “Can I get compensation?”
- “What about my baggage?”

Every answer is **grounded in SkyJet's actual policy** and cites the exact clause it came from (e.g. “§4.2: weather delay over 6h overnight → hotel”). The assistant explains and points, but never acts on its own — the passenger (and the rules engine) stay in control of any real decision. If it cannot answer, it hands off to an agent rather than guessing.

What we intentionally kept out

Staying true to KISS, the passenger is **not** asked to do things that would add friction or that a self-service tool should not own on its own: real payment entry, account creation / SSO, partner-airline or award rebooking, group / multi-city juggling, or special-assistance cases. Each of those is routed to a human with full context instead — the app knows the limit of what it should automate, and hands off gracefully at exactly that line.

The whole thing, in one breath

A stressed passenger gets a WhatsApp saying their flight is cancelled, taps the link, and — without downloading anything or waiting on hold — sees their flight, understands why it happened and what they are owed, and in a few taps either walks away with a new boarding pass, a refund reference, or a clear plan to wait. If it is ever too complex, a human takes over already knowing everything. That is the entire product: calm, clear, self-service recovery — in under 30 seconds, on the phone already in their hand.